

Jeffrey Sanford Russell

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Metaphysics, Epistemology, Decision Theory, Ethics, Logic,
Philosophy of Religion, Philosophy of Mathematics, Philosophy of Science

Career

University of Southern California

Professor of Philosophy	2022–present
Associate Professor of Philosophy	2017–2022
Assistant Professor of Philosophy	2014–2017

Magdalen College, Oxford University

Tutorial Fellow and CUF Lecturer	2011–2014
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Education

New York University

PhD in Philosophy	2007–2011
Dissertation	<i>Possible Worlds and the Objective World</i>
Committee	Ted Sider (supervisor), Hartry Field, Kit Fine, Michael Strevens

Rutgers University

PhD candidate in Philosophy	2006–2007
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Stanford University

Bachelor of Arts with Distinction in Philosophy	2001–2005
Bachelor of Science with Distinction in Mathematics	
Minor in Symbolic Systems	

Stanford-in-Oxford Programme	Fall 2004
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Awards and Grants

Raubenheimer Senior Faculty Award	2024
<i>The Philosopher's Annual</i> vol. 43, "On Two Arguments for Fanaticism"	2024
<i>The Philosopher's Annual</i> vol. 42, "Multiple Universes and Self-Locating Evidence"	2023
Global Priorities Research Prize	2022
Honorable mention, Alvin Plantinga Prize	2022
Longview grant, <i>Big Decisions: Infinite and Unbounded Values</i>	2021–2023
Marc Sanders Prize in Philosophy of Religion	2021
<i>The Philosopher's Annual</i> vol. 35, "Groupthink"	2015
Oxford Studies in Metaphysics Younger Scholars Prize	2008
MacCracken Fellow, New York University	2007
Rhodes finalist	2005
Barry M. Goldwater Scholar	2004
Phi Beta Kappa, early induction	2003
President's Award for Excellence in the Freshman Year, Stanford University	2001
President's Scholar, Stanford University	2001

Publications

- [1] "Fixing Stochastic Dominance". DOI: [10.1086/728716](https://doi.org/10.1086/728716). Forthcoming in *The British Journal for the Philosophy of Science*.
- [2] With Frank Hong. "Paradoxes of Infinite Aggregation". In: *Noûs* 59.3 (2025), pp. 809–827. DOI: [10.1111/nous.12535](https://doi.org/10.1111/nous.12535).
- [3] "The Value of Normative Information". In: *The Australasian Journal of Philosophy* 103 (2 2025), pp. 469–485. DOI: [10.1080/00048402.2024.2320290](https://doi.org/10.1080/00048402.2024.2320290).
- [4] "On Two Arguments for Fanaticism". In: *Noûs* 58 (3 2024). Selected for *The Philosopher's Annual* vol. 43. Winner of the 2021 Global Priorities Research Prize. GPI Working Paper No. 17–2021., pp. 565–595. DOI: [10.1111/nous.12461](https://doi.org/10.1111/nous.12461).
- [5] With Yoaav Isaacs and Adam Lerner. "Counting Your Chickens". In: *The Australasian Journal of Philosophy* 102 (3 2024), pp. 675–692. DOI: [10.1080/00048402.2024.2309579](https://doi.org/10.1080/00048402.2024.2309579).
- [6] With Yoaav Isaacs. "Updating Without Evidence". In: *Noûs* 57 (3 2023), pp. 576–579. DOI: [10.1111/nous.12426](https://doi.org/10.1111/nous.12426).
- [7] With Charity Anderson. "Divine Hiddenness and Other Evidence". Winner of the Marc Sanders Prize in Philosophy of Religion. Forthcoming in *Oxford Studies in Philosophy of Religion*.
- [8] With Yoaav Isaacs and John Hawthorne. "Multiple Universes and Self-Locating Probabilities". In: *Philosophical Review* 131.3 (2022). Selected for *The Philosopher's Annual* vol. 42. Honorable mention, Alvin Plantinga Prize, pp. 241–294. DOI: [10.1215/00318108-9743809](https://doi.org/10.1215/00318108-9743809).
- [9] With Yoaav Isaacs. "Infinite Prospects". In: *Philosophy and Phenomenological Research* 103.1 (2021), pp. 178–198. DOI: [10.1111/phpr.12704](https://doi.org/10.1111/phpr.12704).
- [10] "On the Probability of Plenitude". In: *Journal of Philosophy* 117 (5 2020), pp. 267–292. DOI: [10.5840/jphil2020117517](https://doi.org/10.5840/jphil2020117517).
- [11] "Non-Archimedean Preferences Over Countable Lotteries". In: *Journal of Mathematical Economics* 88 (May 2020), pp. 180–186. DOI: [10.1016/j.jmateco.2020.03.011](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jmateco.2020.03.011).

- [12] “Sleeping Beauty’s Evidence”. In: *The Routledge Handbook of the Philosophy of Evidence*. Ed. by Maria Lasonen-Aarnio and Clayton Littlejohn. New York: Routledge, 2024.
- [13] “How Much is at Stake for the Pragmatic Encroacher”. In: *Oxford Studies in Epistemology* 6 (2019). DOI: [10.1093/oso/9780198833314.003.0013](https://doi.org/10.1093/oso/9780198833314.003.0013).
- [14] “Quality and Quantifiers”. In: *Australasian Journal of Philosophy* 96.3 (2018), pp. 562–577. DOI: [10.1080/00048402.2017.1363259](https://doi.org/10.1080/00048402.2017.1363259).
- [15] With John Hawthorne. “Possible Patterns”. In: *Oxford Studies in Metaphysics* 11 (2018). DOI: [10.1093/oso/9780198828198.001.0001](https://doi.org/10.1093/oso/9780198828198.001.0001).
- [16] With Andrew Bacon. “The Logic of Opacity”. In: *Philosophy and Phenomenological Research* (2017). DOI: [10.1111/phpr.12454](https://doi.org/10.1111/phpr.12454).
- [17] “Composition as Abstraction”. In: *Journal of Philosophy* 114 (9 2017), pp. 453–470. DOI: [10.5840/jphil2017114931](https://doi.org/10.5840/jphil2017114931).
- [18] With John Hawthorne. “General Dynamic Triviality Theorems”. In: *Philosophical Review* 125 (3 2016), pp. 307–339. DOI: [10.1215/00318108-3516936](https://doi.org/10.1215/00318108-3516936).
- [19] “Qualitative Grounds”. In: *Philosophical Perspectives* 30 (1 2016), pp. 309–348. DOI: [10.1111/phpe.12078](https://doi.org/10.1111/phpe.12078).
- [20] “Temporary Safety Hazards”. In: *Notus* 50 (3 2015). DOI: [10.1111/nous.12104](https://doi.org/10.1111/nous.12104).
- [21] “Indefinite Divisibility”. In: *Inquiry* 59 (3 2015), pp. 239–263. DOI: [10.1080/0020174X.2015.1033006](https://doi.org/10.1080/0020174X.2015.1033006).
- [22] With John Hawthorne and Lara Buchak. “Groupthink”. In: *Philosophical Studies* 172 (5 2015). Selected for *The Philosopher’s Annual*, vol. 35, pp. 1287–1309. DOI: [10.1007/s11098-014-0350-8](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11098-014-0350-8).
- [23] “On Where Things Could Be”. In: *Philosophy of Science* 81 (1 Jan. 2014), pp. 60–80. DOI: [10.1086/674344](https://doi.org/10.1086/674344).
- [24] “Possible Worlds and the Objective World”. In: *Philosophy and Phenomenological Research* (2013). DOI: [10.1111/phpr.12052](https://doi.org/10.1111/phpr.12052).
- [25] “Actuality for Counterpart Theorists”. In: *Mind* (2013). DOI: [10.1093/mind/fzt037](https://doi.org/10.1093/mind/fzt037).
- [26] “The Structure of Gunk: Adventures in the Ontology of Space”. In: *Oxford Studies in Metaphysics*. Ed. by Dean Zimmerman. Vol. 4. Winner of the 2008 Oxford Studies in Metaphysics Younger Scholars Prize. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2008, pp. 248–274.

In Progress (available on request)

- [27] With John Hawthorne. “Metaphysical Constraints on Objective Priors”.
- [28] *The Limits of Logic*. Textbook, draft available online. URL: <https://www.dropbox.com/s/5vj31iuo149plh5/limits.of.logic.pdf>.
- [29] *Extreme Risks: Value in a Vast and Uncertain World*. Book manuscript in preparation.

Presentations

- [1] “New Work for Infinitesimal Probabilities”. Invited talk. Johns Hopkins University, Nov. 14, 2025.

- [2] “The Tyranny of the Infinite”. Seminar presentation. Princeton University, Nov. 12, 2025.
- [3] “Regularity and Representation”. Problems for Bayesianism Workshop. National University of Singapore, Aug. 8, 2025.
- [4] “Moral Arguments for Infinitesimal Probabilities”. 15th Global Priorities Workshop. Oxford, Dec. 10, 2024.
- [5] “New Work for Infinitesimal Probabilities”. Invited talk. Princeton, Dec. 6, 2024.
- [6] “The Long Term and Eternity”. Population-Level Bioethics Consultation. Institute for Health Metrics and Evaluation, Seattle, Washington, July 24, 2024.
- [7] With Yoaav Isaacs. “Updating Without Evidence”. Invited talk, APA Central Division Meeting. New Orleans, Feb. 23, 2024.
- [8] “The Moral Argument for Infinitesimal Probabilities”. Invited talk. Rutgers, Feb. 8, 2024.
- [9] “Infinite Futility”. Plenary session, 13th Oxford Workshop on Global Priorities. Oxford, Dec. 4, 2023.
- [10] “Problems for Impartiality”. Invited talk. MIT, Mar. 3, 2023.
- [11] “Problems for Impartiality”. Mind and Language seminar. New York University, Feb. 28, 2023.
- [12] “Pascal’s Revenge”. Unbounded Utility in Ethics and Decision Theory. Population Well-Being Initiative, UT Austin, Nov. 17, 2022.
- [13] “Problems for Impartiality”. Derek Parfit Memorial Lecture. Global Priorities Institute, University of Oxford, June 16, 2022. URL: <https://globalprioritiesinstitute.org/parfit-memorial-lecture-jeffrey-sanford-russell-problems-for-impartiality/>.
- [14] “Shots in the Dark”. Invited talk. Baylor University, Mar. 25, 2022.
- [15] “Divine Hiddenness and Other Evidence”. Hiddenness Workshop. Baylor University, Nov. 5, 2021.
- [16] “Pascalian Wagers”. 6th Oxford Workshop on Global Priorities Research. University of Oxford (online), Mar. 18, 2021.
- [17] “Infinite Values and Large Finite Values”. 5th Oxford Workshop on Global Priorities Research. University of Oxford (online), Dec. 8, 2020.
- [18] “Teaching the Limits of Logic”. Math Education Seminar. University of Southern California, Mar. 18, 2019.
- [19] “Vague Existence”. NYIP Workshop on Metaphysics in Higher-Order Languages. New York, May 21, 2017.
- [20] “Vague Existence”. Invited talk, Hans Kamp Seminar in Language and Logic. University of Texas, Austin, Mar. 2, 2017.
- [21] “Testimonial Evidence”. Invited talk, Sawyer Seminar in Social Epistemology. Northwestern University, Aug. 27, 2016.
- [22] “The Logic of Opacity”. Workshop on Higher-Order Metaphysics. with Andrew Bacon. Oslo, June 5, 2016.
- [23] “Possible Patterns”. Invited talk, Structure in Metaphysics Workshop. Ertegun House, Oxford, May 30, 2016.
- [24] “Possible Patterns”. Invited talk, Working Group in the History and Philosophy of Logic, Mathematics, and Science. University of California, Berkeley, Oct. 21, 2015.
- [25] “Sleeping Beauty and the Dogmatist”. Invited talk. Baylor University, Apr. 24, 2015.

- [26] “Temporary Safety Hazards”. Ranch Metaphysics Workshop. Tucson, Arizona, Jan. 30, 2015.
- [27] “Indefinite Divisibility”. California Metaphysics Conference on the Relationship Between Logic and Metaphysics. University of Southern California, Jan. 25, 2015.
- [28] “Trivialities”. Invited talk, CRNAP Philosophy of Language Workshop. University of Oxford, June 22, 2014.
- [29] “Quality and Quantifiers”. Invited talk. University of Leeds, Mar. 28, 2014.
- [30] “Monadic Foundations for Probability”. Theoretical Work in Progress Seminar. University of Oxford, Feb. 28, 2014.
- [31] “Quality and Quantifiers”. Stanford University, Mar. 17, 2014.
- [32] “Quality and Quantifiers”. University of Notre Dame, Feb. 14, 2014.
- [33] “On Where Things Could Be”. University of Michigan, Jan. 31, 2014.
- [34] “Quality and Quantifiers”. Columbia University, Jan. 28, 2014.
- [35] “On Where Things Could Be”. Invited talk. University of Southern California, Sept. 27, 2013.
- [36] “Temporary Safety Hazards”. Birmingham Time Workshop. Birmingham, May 1, 2013.
- [37] “How Much is at Stake for the Pragmatic Encroacher”. Epistemology Workshop. Innsbruck, Apr. 11, 2013.
- [38] “Conceptual Revision”. Philosophical Society. University of Oxford, Feb. 1, 2013.
- [39] “On Where Things Could Be”. Invited talk, CRNAP Modality Conference. Princeton University, Nov. 18, 2012.
- [40] “Possible Worlds and the Objective World”. Invited talk, PERSP Metaphysics Seminar. Universitat de Barcelona, Mar. 9, 2012.
- [41] “On Where Things Could Be”. Philosophy of Physics Seminar. University of Oxford, Mar. 1, 2012.
- [42] “Possible Worlds and the Objective World”. Theoretical Works in Progress Seminar. University of Oxford, Feb. 23, 2012.
- [43] “Possible Worlds and the Objective World”. Invited talk. University of Michigan, Jan. 27, 2012.
- [44] “Possible Worlds and the Objective World”. Invited talk. Magdalen College, Oxford, Mar. 2, 2011.
- [45] “The Future in Context”. Oxford Graduate Conference. University of Oxford, Nov. 21, 2010.
- [46] “Indefinite Divisibility”. Arché/CSMN Graduate Conference. St. Andrews University, Nov. 8, 2009.
- [47] “Actuality for Counterpart Theorists”. Phloxshop II: Modality. Humboldt University, Berlin, Sept. 11, 2009.
- [48] “Indefinite Divisibility”. Washington Square Circle. New York University, Jan. 27, 2009.
- [49] “‘Probably If’ and Conditional Probability”. Yale/UConn Graduate Philosophy Conference. University of Connecticut, Nov. 10, 2007.
- [50] “A Domain-Specific Statistical Surface Realizer”. In: *Proceedings of the Student Research Workshop at the 43rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics*. University of Michigan, June 27, 2005.
- [51] “Statistical Natural Language Generation for Navigation Instructions”. CSLI Talk. Stanford University, Aug. 27, 2004.

Comments, Etc.

- [1] Session chair. 8th Higher Order Metaphysics Workshop. New York University, Nov. 16, 2024.
- [2] Invited participant. 14th Global Priorities Workshop. Oxford, June 14, 2024.
- [3] Invited participant. Philosophy and Engineering Retreat on AI Ethics and Safety. University of Southern California, Apr. 26, 2024.
- [4] Academic consultant. Philosophy Fellowship Program. Center for AI Safety, 2023.
- [5] Visiting Researcher. Trinity Term. Global Priorities Institute, University of Oxford, 2022.
- [6] Invited Participant. Ranch Metaphysics Workshop. Jan. 28, 2022.
- [7] Remote Visitor. Trinity Term. Global Priorities Institute, University of Oxford, June 2021.
- [8] William MacAskill, Krister Bykvist, and Toby Ord. “Moral Uncertainty”. Book symposium. Institute for Future Studies, Stockholm, and Australian National University (online), Feb. 4, 2021.
- [9] Jack Spencer. “Is Non-Fundamental Existence Relative?” Metaphysics on the Mountain Workshop (online). July 3, 2020.
- [10] Invited Participant. Ranch Metaphysics Workshop. Jan. 28, 2019.
- [11] Martin Glazier. “What Time is it in Other Possible Worlds?” APA Eastern Division Meeting. Savannah, Jan. 4, 2018.
- [12] Olla Solomyak. “The Meta-Metaphysics of Distant Entities: Unifying the Temporal and Modal Domains”. APA Eastern Division Meeting. Savannah, Jan. 4, 2018.
- [13] Michael Bergmann. “Skeptical Theism, Representativeness, and Radical Uncertainty”. APA Central Division Meeting. Kansas City, Mar. 3, 2017.
- [14] Invited Participant. Ranch Metaphysics Workshop. Jan. 25, 2017.
- [15] Peter van Inwagen. “The Rev’d Mr. Bayes and the Life Everlasting”. International Conference on New Insights and Directions for Religious Epistemology. St Anne’s College, University of Oxford, June 23, 2015.
- [16] Visiting Fellow. Princeton University, fall semester, 2013.
- [17] Eli Hirsch. “Talmudic Destiny”. Association for the Philosophy of Judaism. online symposium, July 28, 2013. URL: <http://www.theapj.com/symposium-on-eli-hirschs-talmudic-destiny-28-august-04-july/>.
- [18] Tim Pickavance and Daniel Eaton. “Wagering on Pragmatic Encroachment”. Religious Epistemology, Contextualism, and Pragmatic Encroachment Workshop. University of Oxford, Mar. 14, 2013.
- [19] Internal visitor. New Insights and Directions for Religious Epistemology. University of Oxford, 2013.
- [20] Huiming Ren. “Inverted Earth Revisited”. Meiguo Metaphysical Mayhem. Peking University, June 2012.
- [21] Lara Buchak. “Risk and Tradeoffs”. Meiguo Metaphysical Mayhem. Peking University, June 2012.
- [22] Commentator-at-large. California Metaphysics Conference. University of Southern California, Jan. 21, 2012.
- [23] Timothy Williamson. “Metaphysics and Higher-Order Modal Logic”. Oxford Metaphysics Workshop. University of Oxford, Sept. 25, 2011.

- [24] Invited participant. St. Thomas Summer Seminar in Philosophy of Religion and Philosophical Theology. University of St. Thomas, June 2011.
- [25] Aaron Segal. “Identity Variance”. APA Eastern. Boston, Dec. 30, 2010.
- [26] Invited participant. St. Thomas Summer Seminar in Philosophy of Religion and Philosophical Theology. University of St. Thomas, June 2010.
- [27] Sean Aas. “Modality: Norms and Naturalism”. NYU/Columbia Graduate Philosophy Conference. New York University, Mar. 7, 2009.
- [28] Katrina Przyjemski. “A Monstrous Semantics for Anaphoric Pronouns”. NYU / Columbia Graduate Philosophy Conference. Columbia University, Mar. 1, 2008.
- [29] Joshua Rasmussen. “A Scotistic Cosmological Argument for the Existence of God”. Religion at Rutgers. Rutgers University, Jan. 13, 2007.

Graduate Supervising

Past dissertation committees

Jaime Castillo Gamboa <i>Vagueness, Ontology, and the Social World</i> Visiting Assistant Professor, Hamilton College	PhD 2024
Weng Kin San <i>Aggregation and the Structure of Value</i> Assistant Professor, London School of Economics	supervisor — PhD 2024
Quyen Pham <i>The Metaphysics of Social Groups: Structure, Location, and Change</i> Lecturer, Harvard University	PhD 2024
Zachary Goodsell <i>Unbounded Utility</i> Assistant Professor, National University of Singapore	co-supervisor with Andrew Bacon — PhD 2023
Noah Gordon <i>Theism and Secular Modality</i> Technical communications and information modelling	supervisor — PhD 2023
Frank Hong <i>Uncertain Knowledge</i> Assistant Professor, Texas Tech University	co-supervisor with Andrew Bacon — PhD 2023
Mahmoud Jalloh <i>Dimensional Analysis: Essays on the Metaphysics and Epistemology of Quantities</i> Post-doctoral research fellow, Caltech	co-supervisor with Porter Williams — PhD 2023
James Milford <i>An Examination of Certain Counterpart Accounts</i> Cyber security analyst	external examiner — Oxford, DPhil 2022

Simon Campion (Blessenohl) co-supervisor with Jonathan Quong — PhD 2021
Political Decision-Making in an Uncertain World
 Research software engineer, DeepL

Lu Chen University of Massachusetts, PhD 2020
Continua
 Assistant Professor, University of Southern California

Matt Leonard PhD 2019
What It Is To Be Located
 Associate Professor, California Baptist University

Maegan Fairchild PhD 2018
Unlimited Ontology and Its Limits
 Associate Professor, University of Michigan

Thomas Møller-Nielsen co-supervisor with Oliver Pooley — Oxford, DPhil 2016
Symmetry and the Generalist Picture
 Journalist

Current committees

Grace Atkins	metaphysics
Antonio Cleani	logic, metaphysics
Madiha Hamdi	decision theory
Milana Kostic	epistemology, decision theory
Philip Li	co-supervisor with Ralph Wedgwood — ethics
Yasha Sapir	supervisor — epistemology, language
Levy Wang	epistemology, bioethics
Matthew Wiseman	political philosophy

Teaching

Graduate

Value in a Vast and Uncertain World	(Phil 540) Spring 2025
Dissertation Seminar	(Phil 700) 2023–2024, Spring 2025
Epistemology	(Phil 570) with John Hawthorne, Spring 2020
Identity Confusion	(Phil 551) with Andrew Bacon, Fall 2016
Metaphysics	(Phil 560) with Shieva Kleinschmidt, Spring 2016
Epistemology and Metaphysics of Time and Space	(Phil 570) Fall 2014
Philosophy of Logic and Language	BPhil Seminar, with Cian Dorr, Michaelmas 2011
Metaphysics	BPhil Tutorials, various terms 2011–2014
Philosophy of Language	BPhil Tutorials, various terms 2011–2014

Undergraduate

The Limits of Logic	(Phil 450) F14, F15, S17, F18, F19, F22, F23
Probability and Rational Choice	(Phil 258g) S19, F19, S21, F21, F25
Philosophy of Economics	(Phil 339) S26
Philosophy of Religion	(Phil 361) S15, S19
The End of the World	(GESM 120) S21
Minds and Machines: Philosophy of Artificial Intelligence	(GESM 120) S17
Frege's <i>Foundations of Arithmetic</i>	Lectures, Trinity 2013 and 2014
Undergraduate Tutorials	various terms 2011–2014
Introduction to Logic, Elements of Deductive Logic, General Philosophy, The Leibniz-Clarke Correspondence, Ethics, Knowledge and Reality, Formal Logic, Philosophy of Logic and Language, Philosophy of Science, Philosophy of Mathematics	

Professional Service

Director of Graduate Studies	2023–2025
Graduate Studies	2015–2016, 2018–2019, 2022–2025
Placement	2014–2023; co-chair 2019–2020; director 2021–2023
Climate	2016–2017, 2021–2023, chair 2025–present
Diversity Liaison	2017–2020
GPS California workshop organizing committee	2018
Graduate Admissions	2014–2015, 2019–2021
USC Society of Fellows Admissions	2018, 2019
Faculty Search Committee	2017–2018, 2022, 2023
Dornsife Committee on Academic Promotion and Tenure	ad hoc member, 2026
Promotion Committees	2018, 2022, 2023
Fifth Year Review Committees	chair 2021, chair 2025
Third Year Review Committees	2019–2020, 2024
Faculty Mentor	2019–2022, 2024–present
Metaphysics Subject Co-Editor, <i>Pacific Philosophical Quarterly</i>	2016–2019
Co-convener, Philosophical Society, Oxford	2014
Magdalen College Governing Body	2011–2014
Magdalen College Tutorial Board	2011–2014
Magdalen College Library and Archives Committee	2012–2014
Referee	
<i>American Philosophical Quarterly, Dialectica, Economics and Philosophy, Ergo, Journal of Philosophical Logic, Journal of Philosophy, Mind, Oxford University Press, Pacific Philosophical Quarterly, Philosophers' Imprint, Philosophia, Philosophical Quarterly, Philosophical Review, Philosophical Studies, Synthese</i>	
NYU Philosophy computer & website maintenance	2008–2011
Co-organizer, NYU/Columbia Graduate Conference	2008

Research Experience Outside Philosophy

Robert Bosch Corp. Research and Technology Center Computational linguistics & artificial intelligence Supervisor: Fuliang Weng	2005–2006
Center for the Study of Language and Information, Semantics Lab Computational linguistics Supervisor: Stanley Peters	2004–2005
U. Washington, Research Experiences for Undergraduates Mathematics Supervisor: James Morrow	Summer 2003
Philips/Heartstream Applied mathematics, signal processing Supervisor: Stacy Gehman	Summer 2002